

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Azure Security | Microsoft Sentinel | Zero Trust | Identity and Access Management | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, implementing, and maintaining enterprise-grade cybersecurity defences, with a deep focus on Microsoft security technologies, Zero Trust architecture, and identity and access management. I have extensive hands-on experience with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) with KQL), Azure Security Centre and Entra ID, having led the full deployment and ongoing management of these platforms across a complex hybrid environment serving over 8,000 users. I hold the CISSP certification and bring deep knowledge of security frameworks including the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus. I have a proven track record in vulnerability management, incident response, and compliance assurance, and I am looking to bring this expertise to a public-sector organisation where technology and security can make a meaningful difference to people's lives.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, User and Entity Behaviour Analytics (UEBA), SOAR playbooks, workbooks)
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** MDE, MDI, Defender for Cloud Apps, Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Cloud
- **Azure Security:** Azure Security Centre, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Zero Trust Architecture:** Identity-driven access control, least-privilege enforcement, Conditional Access policies, continuous verification
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus, CVSS-based risk prioritisation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK Framework
- **Security Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover), Microsoft MDE
- **MDM/MAM:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management / Mobile Application Management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR playbook development, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR)
- **Networking and Perimeter Security:** Firewalls, Intrusion Detection / Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS), Check Point Harmony

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UoA) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst (Eng)

March 2025 to Present

- Design and implement security controls for Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 environments, managing threat policies, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), Conditional Access and Entra ID configuration across an 8,000-user hybrid estate.
- Administer Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, building KQL detection analytics rules, dashboards and automated SOAR playbooks to accelerate detection and response to security events.
- Lead Zero Trust security implementation, enforcing Conditional Access policies, MFA enrolment and least-privilege access controls across cloud and on-premises infrastructure.

- Manage Identity and Access Management (IAM) processes, including provisioning, deprovisioning, role-based access control (RBAC) and privileged account governance via BeyondTrust PAM.
- Deploy and manage the full Microsoft Defender suite, including MDE, MDI, Defender for Cloud Apps and Microsoft 365 Defender, providing integrated, unified threat protection across identity, endpoint and cloud workloads for over 8,000 users.
- Conduct security assessments and vulnerability testing using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS and AppCheck, identifying and mitigating risks and reporting compliance posture to senior stakeholders.
- Lead incident response activities in line with NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle and MITRE ATT&CK framework, managing containment, eradication and recovery across all incident severities.
- Ensure ongoing compliance with ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus, performing gap assessments and driving continuous improvement in security controls.
- Develop and maintain security policies, procedures and standards, and deliver security awareness training across the organisation.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 to March 2025

- Monitored and investigated security events using Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, applying KQL and SPL queries for threat detection, threat hunting and detection rule tuning.
- Administered Entra ID / Azure AD, managing Conditional Access policy configuration, MFA enforcement and SSO integration for enterprise applications in line with Zero Trust principles.
- Maintained compliance with Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001 controls, supporting annual accreditation, audit evidence gathering and risk register maintenance.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io and Nessus, reporting on compliance posture and overdue remediation to senior management.
- Developed and maintained incident response playbooks and runbooks aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, improving response consistency across the security team.
- Implemented and managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, enforcing endpoint compliance policies and ensuring device security posture met organisational standards.
- Performed identity lifecycle management, supporting joiners, movers and leavers processes and RBAC reviews across the enterprise.

HEX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 to March 2022

- Administered security infrastructure within a Microsoft Azure-based SaaS/FinTech environment, managing identity management, endpoint protection and cloud security controls.
- Supported Zero Trust implementation by enforcing MFA, Conditional Access and least-privilege access policies for all users and privileged accounts.
- Performed vulnerability assessments and security risk analysis, producing findings reports and remediation recommendations aligned to CIS Controls and ISO 27001.
- Maintained security monitoring across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, supporting incident identification and escalation to the security team.
- Managed MDM/MAM configuration for mobile and endpoint devices, ensuring compliance with organisational security policies and patch management requirements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the full deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity and Microsoft 365 Defender across an 8,000-user enterprise at UAL, achieving unified threat visibility across identity, endpoint and cloud workloads and improving the organisation's Microsoft Secure Score.
- Built and optimised Microsoft Sentinel KQL analytics rules, UEBA policies and SOAR playbooks, reducing false positive rates and improving mean time to detect and respond (MTTD/MTTR) for high-priority security alerts.
- Implemented a Zero Trust Conditional Access framework using Entra ID, enforcing MFA and risk-based access controls across all user populations, directly supporting successful Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation.

- Established a structured vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, reducing critical vulnerability exposure by systematically prioritising and tracking remediation of high-risk assets.
- Developed comprehensive incident response playbooks aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, reducing average incident response time and improving regulatory compliance posture across ISO 27001 and NIST CSF controls.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP85,000 | Hybrid (Bedford/London, UK)